CHEAT SHEET

Emergency calling checklist

Protocol and the US obligations engineers are asked about

RFC 6881 is the best current practice for emergency calling in SIP. A service URN identifies the emergency call. RFC 6442 carries location in the signaling. The location object itself is civic or geospatial data, not a guess from the caller's extension.

In the United States, the FCC's MLTS page describes Kari's Law and RAY BAUM's Act for multi-line systems: direct 911, notification, and a dispatchable location. Other countries write different rules. Confirm the obligation with the authority where the lines are, and with the provider that will deliver the call. A lab test uses the test number that provider gave you.

RFC 6881 · RFC 6442 · FCC MLTS 911 requirements

Emergency checklist

- Emergency route is explicit. It does not depend on a least-cost route that can hairpin the wrong way.
- Location is configured for the site, the network, or the device, matching the product you deployed.
- Notification path for on-site staff is tested if the law that applies to you requires it.
- A move, add, or remote worker has an owner for the new location.
- The test call uses the provider's test procedure.

Sources and go deeper

- RFC 6881 — last checked 2026-10
- RFC 6442 — last checked 2026-10
- FCC MLTS 911 requirements — confirm

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